



uniquely patterned coat gives alternative name of painted dog

African wild dog

Lycaon pictus

Highly adaptable, African wild dogs live in a variety of habitats across sub-Saharan Africa. Like many members of the dog family, African wild dogs live in packs and hunt cooperatively. A pack consists of four to nine adults with one dominant breeding pair and their pups. New packs usually form when siblings of the same sex leave their birth pack and join with a group of the opposite sex from another pack—a behavior that reduces inbreeding.

Wild dog packs require large home ranges—typically around 290sq miles (750sq km). Medium-sized antelope such as impala and Thomson's gazelles make up the majority of their prey. However, some packs have developed specialized skills for hunting different savanna animals such as zebras and ostriches. Wild dogs are threatened by habitat loss, human persecution, traffic, and diseases such as rabies and canine distemper; the latter is caught from domestic dogs.

↔ 34–55 in (86–140 cm)
 ⚖ 40–77 lb (18–35 kg)
 ⊗ Endangered
 🦋 Impala, blue wildebeest
 🏠 🌿 🌿 🌿



Sub-Saharan Africa

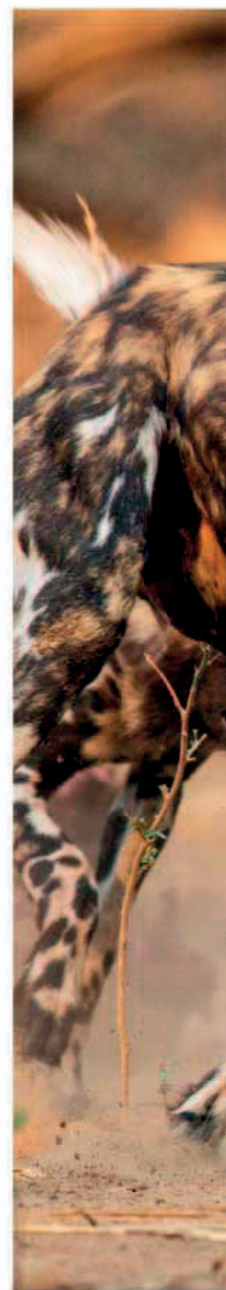


△ FACE OFF

Notoriously tough-skinned and aggressive in defense, a pair of honey badgers fight off an attack by a pack of wild dogs despite their inferior size.

▷ RARE AGGRESSION

Fights, either for dominance or for food, are rare within a pack. African wild dogs rely on cooperation for their survival.

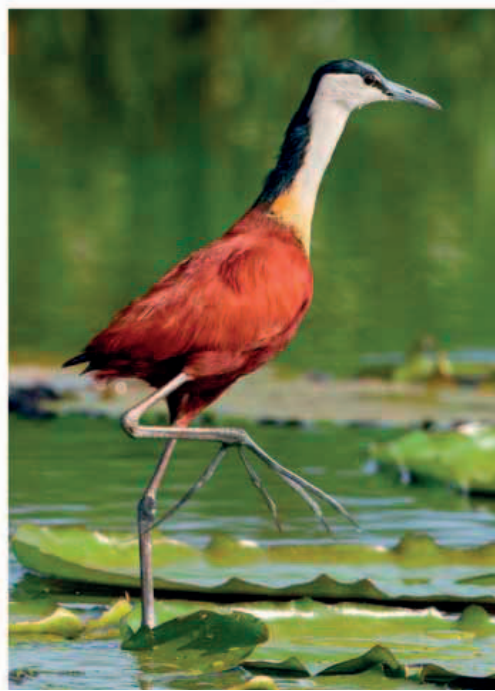


African jacana

Actophilornis africanus

Equipped with long toes and sharp claws, jacanas move elegantly over floating leaves, but are as likely to perch on top of a swimming hippopotamus. The jacana eats whatever it can reach in the water and on submerged stems and leaves. It snatches bees from lily flowers, dipping them into the water before swallowing. Typically, several jacanas feed on a marsh, but keep their distance, calling and chasing should another venture too near.

Female jacanas mate with several males and lay about four eggs in each of their nests. The male incubates them over 21–26 days. He also cares for the chicks, often carrying his brood beneath his wings, which are specially adapted for this purpose.



↔ 12 in (30 cm)
 ⚖ 5–9 oz (150–250 g)
 ⊗ Common
 🦋 Insects, mollusks
 🏠 🌿
 📍 Sub-Saharan Africa

◁ LILY TROTTER

As one leaf gradually sinks beneath it, the lily-trotting jacana steps to the next, curling over leaf edges with its beak to find snails and beetles.